

should make their students read the two articles. I hope all poor students take inspiration from their Bihar brethren and work hard to become achievers in life. The two articles also highlight the importance of family values.

P.V.R. SOMANADHA SARMA,
via www.indiatoday.in

No Mean Feat

The OBC quota has helped, but beyond that it is the sheer grit and struggle of an individual to cross the IT hurdle ("Equal to the Test", June 29). It is indeed heartening to see such people in Bihar. This is definitely a state that has always produced best of talent in diverse fields.

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA,
Mysore

Small Wonders

The story on Afsha Musani, 5, and Dhairya Sorecha, 10, hosting *Sa Re Ga Ma Pa Li'l Champs* makes for an interesting food for thought ("Child Lock", June 29). Not a very pleasant one, though. At a very young age, kids are being pressured into acting in television serials. In addition, they are also required to generate TRPs for the channels. Is this not child labour?

DR V. RAMAPRASAD,
Tamil Nadu

Clean-up Act

The story on the cleaning up of the judicial system is welcome news for most of

us ("Judges on Trial", June 29). If errant judges can be tackled in Gujarat, then why can't the same happen in Tamil Nadu too where they abound in plenty? All these 46 years when I stepped into the courts as a lawyer, I was witness to judicial values taking a backseat steadily. For people like us, the Gujarat example offers a ray of hope.

VASUNDHARA VASUDEVAN,
Chengalpattu, Tamil Nadu
PTI



Exploiting people's sentiments for votebank politics and pitting Marathis against non-Maharashtrians is taking its toll on Maharashtra's overall development.

MAHESH KUMAR, Delhi

Saving Grace

The Indian cricket team should be complimented for being out of the T-20 World Cup because it saved a lot of public money and resources, like the plots of land, which would have been showered on our cricketers if they had won ("The Seven Deadly

Spins", June 29). Indian fans also saved a lot of their time which otherwise would have been spent on viewing cricket matches.

MADHU AGRAWAL, Delhi

Stop Abuse

It is disappointing that advanced countries like Australia have failed to secure Indian students from racial attacks ("The Fear Factor", June 15). Despite the attacks on their friends, Indian

students took out peace marches instead of taking law into their hands. This reflects the courteousness of Indian students, and the authorities in Australia should keep this in mind while dealing with the situation.

IPPILI SANTHOSH KUMAR,
via www.indiatoday.in

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

AUGUST 16-31, 1979

The Domino Effect

The outcome of the political power game being played at the Centre will have its repercussions in the states too. With the last month fall of the Janata Government headed by Morarji Desai, the nine Janata-ruled state governments are in trouble and at least five of them are in danger of imminent collapse. In Gujarat, Bihar and Haryana, prime minister Charan Singh's men are trying to topple the Janata ministries, whereas in Uttar Pradesh, the Janata Party is retaliating against the government of Banarasi Das, who has conveniently defected to Janata (S). In Assam, the socialists are sniping at a fellow socialist, Golap Borbora, and in Himachal Pradesh, it is Jan Sangh versus Jan Sangh. While in Assam the Communist Party of India-Marxist (CPI-M) plays the kingmaker's role, it is the Congress (I)'s privilege in the other four states. In most of the states, ministry-making will be more difficult than it has been at the Centre.



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